

CS 214: Introduction to Data Systems

Course Syllabus - Fall Term

1. Course Description

This course introduces the design and operation of systems that store, organise, and retrieve structured and unstructured data. Students will study indexing, query processing, and the practical tradeoffs involved in building dependable data infrastructure. No prior database coursework is assumed.

Instructor and Meetings

Instructor: Dr. A. Verity. Office hours are held Tuesdays and Thursdays from 14:00 to 16:00 in Kessler Hall, room 312, and by appointment. The course meets twice weekly for eighty minutes per session.

2. Grading

The final course grade is calculated from four components: weekly assignments account for 40 percent, the midterm examination for 25 percent, the final examination for 30 percent, and in-class participation for the remaining 5 percent.

Table 2.1 - Letter grade scale

Letter	Percentage range	Standing
A	90 and above	Excellent
B	80 to 89	Good
C	70 to 79	Satisfactory
D	60 to 69	Marginal pass
F	below 60	Failing

Any final score below 60 percent is recorded as a failing grade and does not earn credit toward the degree.

3. Deadlines and Regrades

Assignments submitted after the posted deadline lose 10 percent of the available marks for each day they are late. Submissions are no longer accepted once an assignment is five days overdue, and a score of zero is recorded.

Students who believe an assignment has been marked incorrectly may request a regrade within seven calendar days of receiving the mark. Requests must be submitted in writing and must explain which specific criterion the student believes was misapplied.

Regrade requests are reviewed by the instructor of record. The reviewed mark may be higher or lower than the original mark, and the reviewed mark is final.

4. Credit and Progression

A minimum final grade of C is required for this course to count toward the major requirements. Students who finish with a D may still receive elective credit, but must retake the course before enrolling in any dependent upper-level course.

Enrolment in CS 314 and CS 322 is conditional on completion of this course at the required standard. The department does not grant waivers on the basis of professional experience.